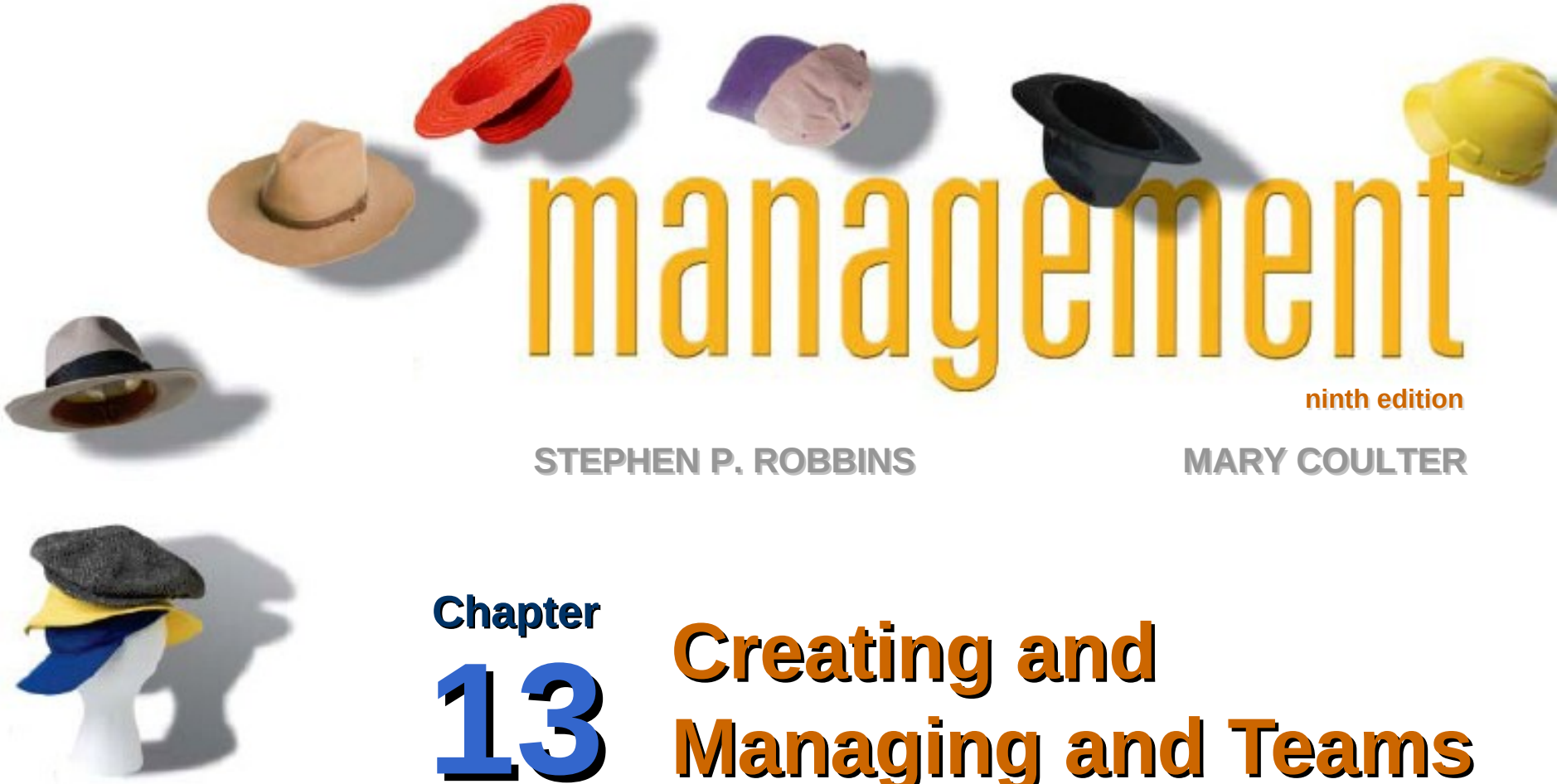

ninth edition

STEPHEN P. ROBBINS MARY COULTER

Chapter

13 Creating and Managing and Teams

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PowerPoint Presentation by Charlie Cook
The University of West Alabama

LEARNING OUTLINE

Follow this Learning Outline as you read and study this chapter.

Understanding Groups

- Define the different types of groups.
- Describe the five stages of group development.

Explaining Work Group Behavior

- Explain the major components that determine group performance and satisfaction.
- Discuss how roles, norms, conformity, status systems, group size, and group cohesiveness influence group behavior.
- Explain how group norms can both help and hurt an organization.
- Define groupthink and social loafing.

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LEARNING OUTLINE (cont'd)

Follow this Learning Outline as you read and study this chapter.

Explaining Work Group Behavior (cont'd)

- Describe the relationships between group cohesiveness and productivity.
- Discuss how conflict management influences group behavior.
- Tell the advantages and disadvantages of group decision making.

Creating Effective Teams

- Compare groups and teams.
- Explain why teams have become so popular in organizations.
- Describe the four most common types of teams.

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LEARNING OUTLINE (cont'd)

Follow this Learning Outline as you read and study this chapter.

Creating Effective Teams (cont'd)

- List the characteristics of effective teams.

Current Challenges in Managing Teams

- Discuss the challenges of managing global teams
- Explain the role of informal (social) networks in managing teams.

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Understanding Groups

- Group
  - Two or more interacting and interdependent individuals who come together to achieve specific goals.
  - Formal groups
    - Work groups defined by the organization's structure that have designated work assignments and tasks.
      - Appropriate behaviors are defined by and directed toward organizational goals.
  - Informal groups
    - Groups that are independently formed to meet the social needs of their members.

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Scenario: Project Team in a Marketing Department

Group Description:

A company forms a **marketing project team** to launch a new product. This team consists of:

- **Sarah** (Marketing Manager)
- **James** (Graphic Designer)
- **Lena** (Content Writer)
- **Arjun** (Data Analyst)

Goal:

To develop and execute a marketing campaign for the launch of a new smartwatch within 3 months.

Interdependence & Interaction:

- Sarah sets the campaign strategy and oversees progress.
- Lena writes engaging promotional content for the website and ads.
- James creates visuals and advertisements based on Lena’s content.
- Arjun analyzes customer data to identify target audiences and provides insights that shape the campaign.

They hold **weekly meetings** to review progress, share feedback, and adjust plans based on market response.

Why This Is a Group:

- They **interact regularly**, collaborate on tasks, and depend on each other's work to succeed.
- They have a **shared goal** (successful product launch).
- They are **interdependent** — one person's output directly impacts the team's ability to meet its goal.

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Scenario: Formal Group in a Bank
Group Name:
Loan Approval Committee at a Commercial Bank
Members:
•**Branch Manager (Chairperson)**
•**Loan Officer**
•**Risk Analyst**
•**Legal Advisor**
Purpose/Goal:
To review and approve business loan applications above Rs100,000.
Structure & Roles:
•The **Loan Officer** presents loan application details.
•The **Risk Analyst** evaluates financial risks and repayment ability.
•The **Legal Advisor** checks for legal compliance and documentation.
•The **Branch Manager** leads the meeting and makes final decisions based on input.
Why This Is a Formal Group:
•Formed by the **bank's organizational structure**
•Members are **assigned** specific roles by management
•Tasked with a **clear organizational objective** (loan assessment)
•Operations follow **formal rules and procedures**

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✅ Example & Scenario: Informal Group at University

Scenario:

In a University, a group of friends regularly meets in the library to study together, even though they are not assigned to the same project or group by a teacher.

Group Members:

- Fatima
- Nabil
- Hira
- Sam

Common Purpose:

They all want to do well in their exams and prefer to study together because:

- They trust each other
- They help explain difficult topics
- They motivate each other to stay focused

They meet during lunch breaks, share notes, quiz each other, and sometimes relax after studying.

Why This Is an Informal Group:

- **Formed naturally** through friendship
- **No official structure or assignment**
- **Shared interest** in doing well academically
- Exists even **without teacher or management direction**

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Exhibit 15–1 Examples of Formal Groups

- Command Groups
  - Groups that are determined by the organization chart and composed of individuals who report directly to a given manager.
- Task Groups
  - Groups composed of individuals brought together to complete a specific job task; their existence is often temporary because once the task is completed, the group disbands.

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Exhibit 15–1 Examples of Formal Groups (cont'd)

- Cross-Functional Teams
  - Groups that bring together the knowledge and skills of individuals from various work areas or groups whose members have been trained to do each others' jobs.
- Self-Managed Teams
  - Groups that are essentially independent and in addition to their own tasks, take on traditional responsibilities such as hiring, planning and scheduling, and performance evaluations.

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✅ Example of a Cross-Functional Team

A **mobile phone company** wants to launch a **new smartphone model**.
To make this happen, they form a **cross-functional team** that includes experts from different departments.

Team Members:

- **Product Manager** – oversees project timeline and objectives
- **Engineer** – works on the hardware and technical specs
- **Software Developer** – designs the phone's operating system and apps
- **Marketing Specialist** – creates promotional strategies and ad campaigns
- **Finance Analyst** – manages the budget and cost estimates
- **Customer Service Rep** – provides insights from customer feedback

❖ Purpose of the Team:

To collaborate on designing, building, marketing, and launching the new smartphone successfully.

Each member brings **unique knowledge and skills** from their department, and they may also be **trained to understand each other's roles** to work more effectively as a team.

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✅ Example of a Self-Managed Team

A **furniture manufacturing company** uses **self-managed teams** on the factory floor to handle the production of office chairs.

Team Members:

6 skilled workers (machine operators, assemblers, quality checkers)

Responsibilities:
In addition to assembling and producing the chairs, the team also:
•**Plans** the daily and weekly production schedule
•**Assigns tasks** among themselves based on skills and availability
•**Hires and trains** new team members when needed
•**Monitors performance** and gives feedback to each other
•**Handles minor maintenance** of their equipment
They **do not report to a direct supervisor** on a daily basis. Instead, they meet once a week with upper management for updates.

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ANOTHER EXAMPLE:

Software Development Company:
A self-managed software team is responsible for developing and maintaining a mobile app. The team:

- Sets its own deadlines and work methods
- Divides work among developers, testers, and designers
- Hires freelancers when needed
- Reviews each other’s code and performance
- Communicates directly with clients

Again, there's no daily manager—they manage themselves.

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Stages in Group Development

- **Forming**
  - The first stage of group development in which people join the group and then define the group's purpose, structure, and leadership
- **Storming**
  - The second stage of group development, characterized by intragroup conflict.
- **Norming**
  - The third stage of group development, characterized by close relationships and cohesiveness
- **Performing**
  - The fourth stage of group development when the group is fully functional and works on group task
- **Adjourning**
  - The final stage of group development for temporary groups during which group members are concerned with wrapping up activities rather than task performance

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Exhibit 15–2 Stages of Group Development

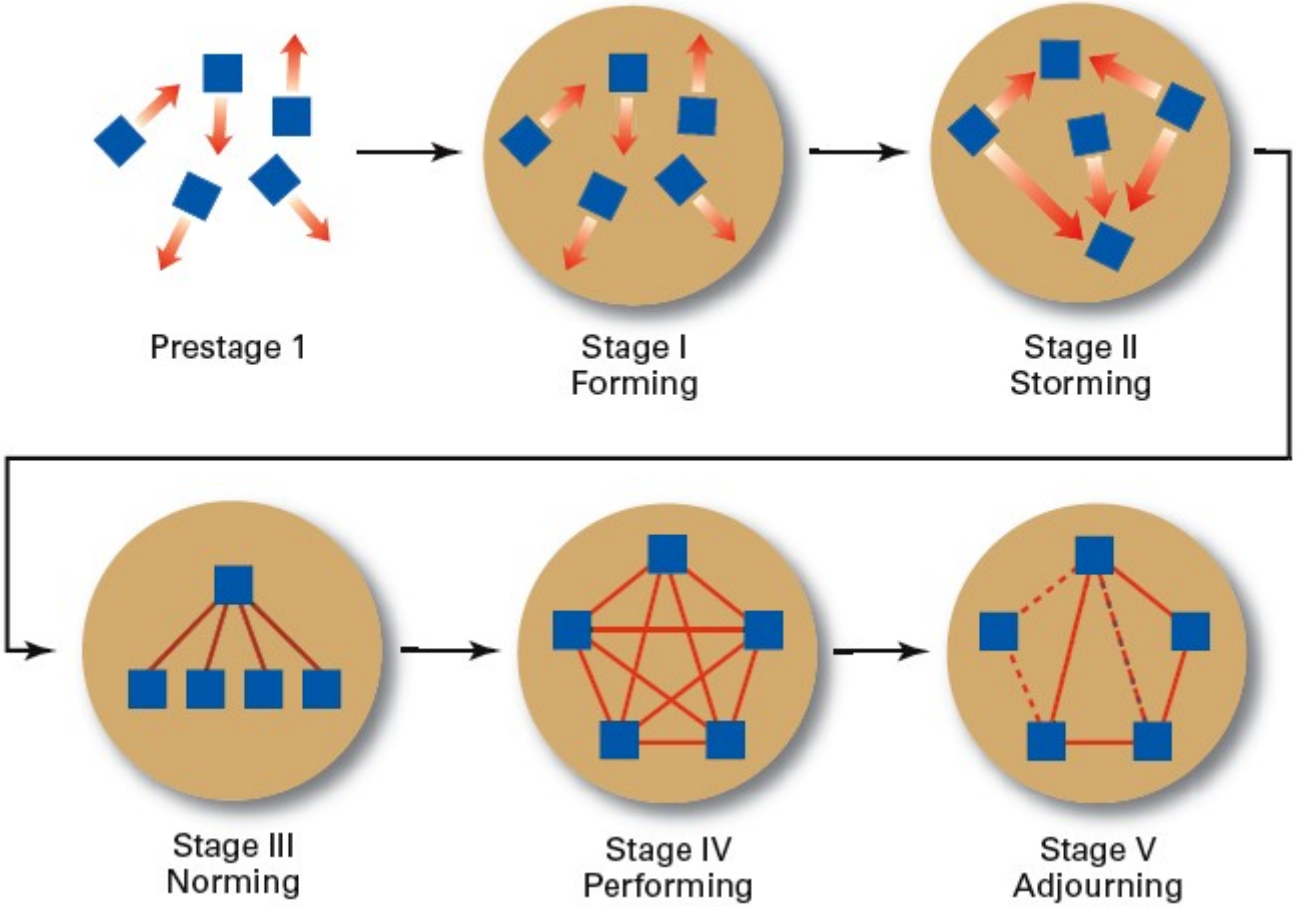

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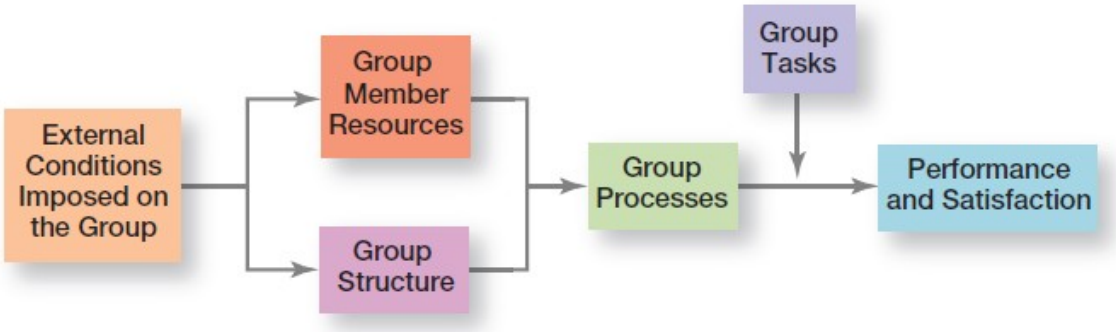
Exhibit 13-3

Group Performance/Satisfaction Model



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Work Group Behavior

- Internal Variables Affecting Group Behavior
  - The individual abilities of the group's members
  - The size of the group
  - The level of conflict
  - The internal pressures on members to conform to the group's norms

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Conditions Affecting Group Behavior

- External (Organizational) Conditions
  - Overall strategy
  - Authority structures
  - Formal regulations
  - Available organizational resources
  - Employee selection criteria
  - Performance management (appraisal) system
  - Organizational culture
  - General physical layout
- Internal Group Variables
  - Individual competencies and traits of members
  - Group structure
  - Size of the group
  - Cohesiveness and the level of intragroup conflict
  - Internal pressures on members to conform o the group's norms

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Group Structure

- Role
  - The set of expected behavior patterns attributed to someone who occupies a given position in a social unit that assist the group in task accomplishment or maintaining group member satisfaction.
  - Role conflict: experiencing differing role expectations
  - Role ambiguity: uncertainty about role expectations

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Group Structure (cont'd)

- Norms
  - Acceptable standards or expectations that are shared by the group's members.
- Common types of norms
  - Effort and performance
    - Output levels, absenteeism, promptness, socializing
  - Dress
  - Loyalty

Common Types of Norms

1.👉 Effort and Performance Norms

These norms govern how much work or effort is expected from members.

1. **Output levels**: How productive members should be (e.g., meeting sales targets).
2. **Absenteeism**: Expectations around attendance or being present.
3. **Promptness**: Being on time to meetings or tasks.
4. **Socializing**: How much casual conversation or interaction is acceptable during work hours.

2.👉 Dress Norms

1. Expectations for how group members should dress (e.g., formal vs. casual attire).
2. This can vary by workplace culture, role, or industry.

3.👉 Loyalty Norms

1. Expectations around **allegiance and commitment** to the group or organization.
2. Could involve protecting group interests, supporting team decisions, or staying with the company long-term.

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Group Structure (cont'd)

- Conformity
- ✅ **What is Conformity?**
- Conformity is when **individuals adjust their behavior, attitudes, or beliefs** to match those of a group. This often happens because people want to be **accepted**, **liked**, or **respected** by others in the group.
  - Group pressures can have an effect on an individual member's judgment and attitudes.
  - **Groupthink**

    When a group exerts extensive pressure on an individual to align his or her opinion with others' opinions.

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✅ What is Groupthink?

•Groupthink happens when **the desire for harmony and agreement becomes more important than making the right decision**.

•In such groups, members **suppress doubts**, **avoid conflict**, and **go along** with decisions—even bad ones.

🔍 Example:

•A business team might ignore warning signs of a bad investment because everyone wants to show unity.

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Group Structure (cont'd)

Status

A prestige grading, position, or rank within a group.

- Status System
  - The formal or informal prestige grading, position, or ranking system for members of a group that serves as recognition for individual contributions to the group and as a behavioral motivator.
    - Formal status systems are effective when the perceived ranking of an individual and the status symbols accorded that individual are congruent.

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Formal status systems :are systems in organizations that clearly show a person's **position or rank**, like job titles (e.g., manager, director) or rewards (e.g., office size, company car).
They are **effective** when:

- The **rank someone has** matches (is congruent with)
- The **status symbols** they receive (like salary, office, title, etc.).

Example:
If someone is a **senior manager** and they have a **big office and high pay**, people see that the rank and the rewards match. This makes the system feel fair and effective.
But if a **junior employee** gets the same perks as a senior manager, people might feel the system is unfair or confusing.

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Group Structure: Group Size

- **Small groups**
  - Complete tasks faster than larger groups.
  - Make more effective use of facts.
- **Large groups**
  - Solve problems better than small groups.
  - Are good for getting diverse input.
  - Are more effective in fact-finding.
- **Social Loafing**
  - The tendency for individuals to expend less effort when working collectively than when work individually.

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Group Structure (cont'd)

- Group Cohesiveness
  - The degree to which members are attracted to a group and share the group's goals.
    - Highly cohesive groups are more effective and productive than less cohesive groups when their goals aligned with organizational goals.

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Exhibit 15–5 The Relationship Between Cohesiveness and Productivity

Alignment of Group and Organizational Goals	Cohesiveness: High	Cohesiveness: Low
High	Strong Increase in Productivity	Moderate Increase in Productivity
Low	Decrease in Productivity	No Significant Effect on Productivity

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Group Processes: Group Decision Making

- **Advantages**
  - Generates more complete information and knowledge.
  - Generates more diverse alternatives.
  - Increases acceptance of a solution.
  - Increases legitimacy of decision.
- **Disadvantages**
  - Time consuming
  - Minority domination
  - Pressures to conform
  - Ambiguous responsibility

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Exhibit 15–6 Group versus Individual Decision Making

Criteria of Effectiveness	Groups	Individuals
Accuracy	✓	
Speed		✓
Creativity	✓	
Degree of acceptance	✓	
Efficiency		✓

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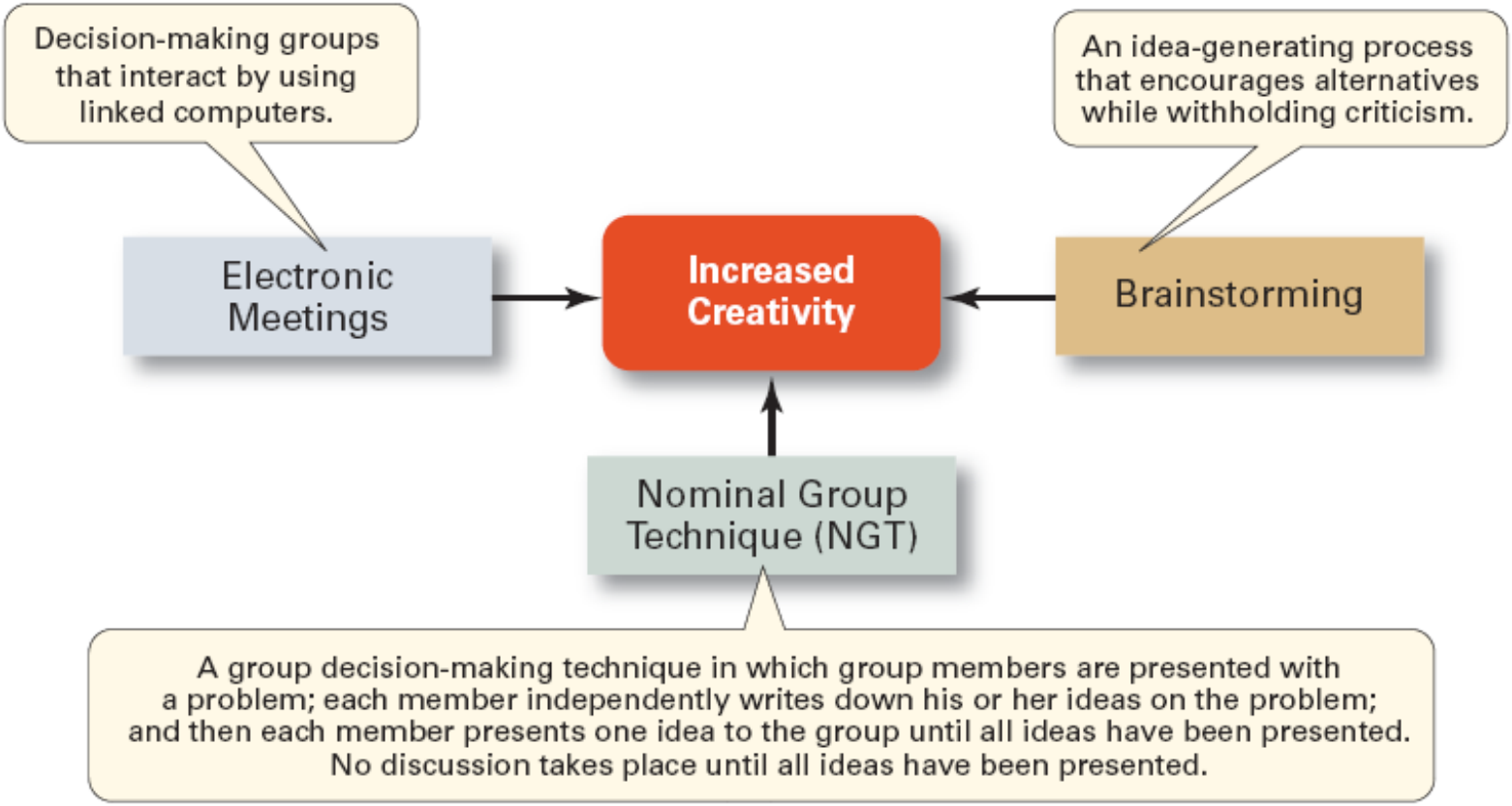
Exhibit 15–7 Techniques for Making More Creative Group Decisions



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Group Processes: Conflict Management

- Conflict
  - The perceived incompatible differences in a group resulting in some form of interference with or opposition to its assigned tasks.
    - **Traditional view:** conflict must be avoided.
    - **Human relations view:** conflict is a natural and inevitable outcome in any group.
    - **Interactionist view:** conflict can be a positive force and is absolutely necessary for effective group performance.

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Group Processes: Conflict Management (cont'd)

- Categories of Conflict
  - Functional conflicts are constructive.
  - Dysfunctional conflicts are destructive.
- Types of Conflict
  - Task conflict: content and goals of the work
  - Relationship conflict: interpersonal relationships
  - Process conflict: how the work gets done

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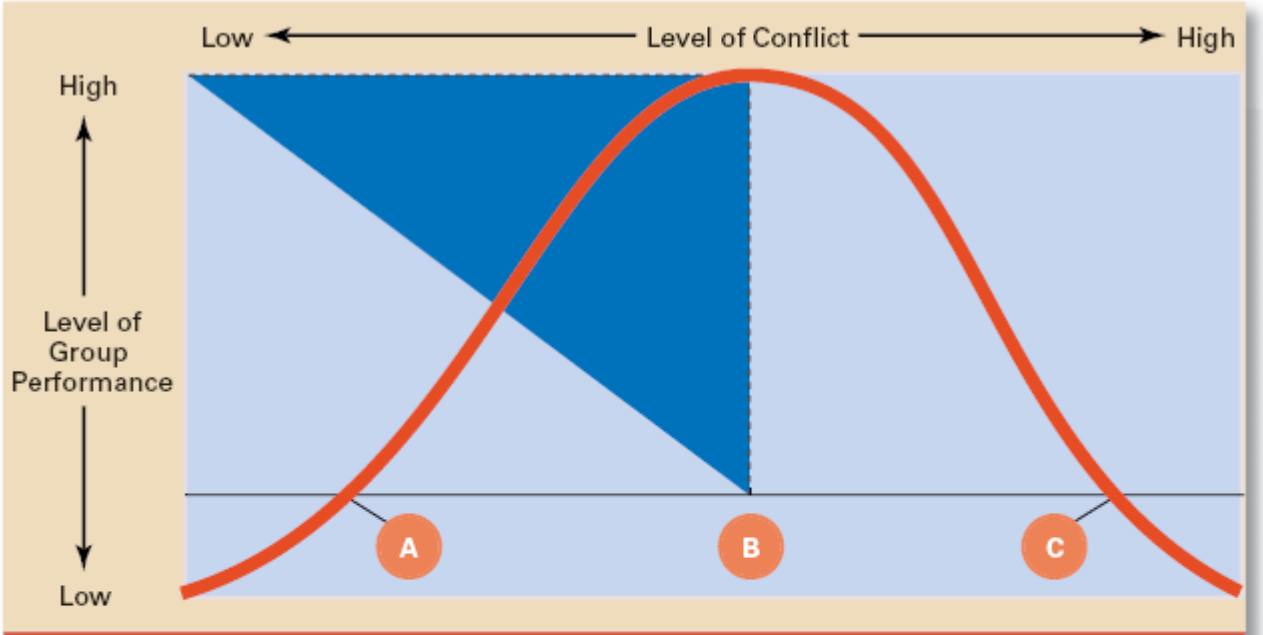
Exhibit 15–8 Conflict and Group Performance



Situation	A	B	C
Level of Conflict	Low or none	Optimal	High
Type of Conflict	Dysfunctional	Functional	Dysfunctional
Group's Internal Characteristics	Apathetic Stagnant Unresponsive to Change Lack of New Ideas	Viable Self-Critical Innovative	Disruptive Chaotic Uncooperative
Level of Group Performance	Low	High	Low

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🔄 **Three Conflict Situations (A, B, C):**

A. Low or No Conflict

•**Type of Conflict:** Dysfunctional

•**Group Characteristics:**

- Apathetic
- Stagnant
- Unresponsive to change
- Lacks new ideas

•**Performance:** Low

⟶ The group lacks energy or drive because there is no challenge or disagreement.

B. Optimal Conflict (Middle Point of the Curve)

•**Type of Conflict:** Functional

•**Group Characteristics:**

- Viable
- Self-critical
- Innovative

•**Performance:** High

⟶ This is the ideal scenario. The group experiences just enough conflict to encourage creativity, debate, and better decision-making, but not so much that it becomes disruptive.

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C. High Conflict

- **Type of Conflict:** Dysfunctional
- **Group Characteristics:**
  - Disruptive
  - Chaotic
  - Uncooperative
- **Performance:** Low

⟶ Excessive conflict overwhelms the group, leading to breakdowns in communication, hostility, and inefficiency.

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Group Processes: Conflict Management (cont'd)

- Techniques to Reduce Conflict:
  - Avoidance
  - Accommodation
  - Forcing
  - Compromise
  - Collaboration

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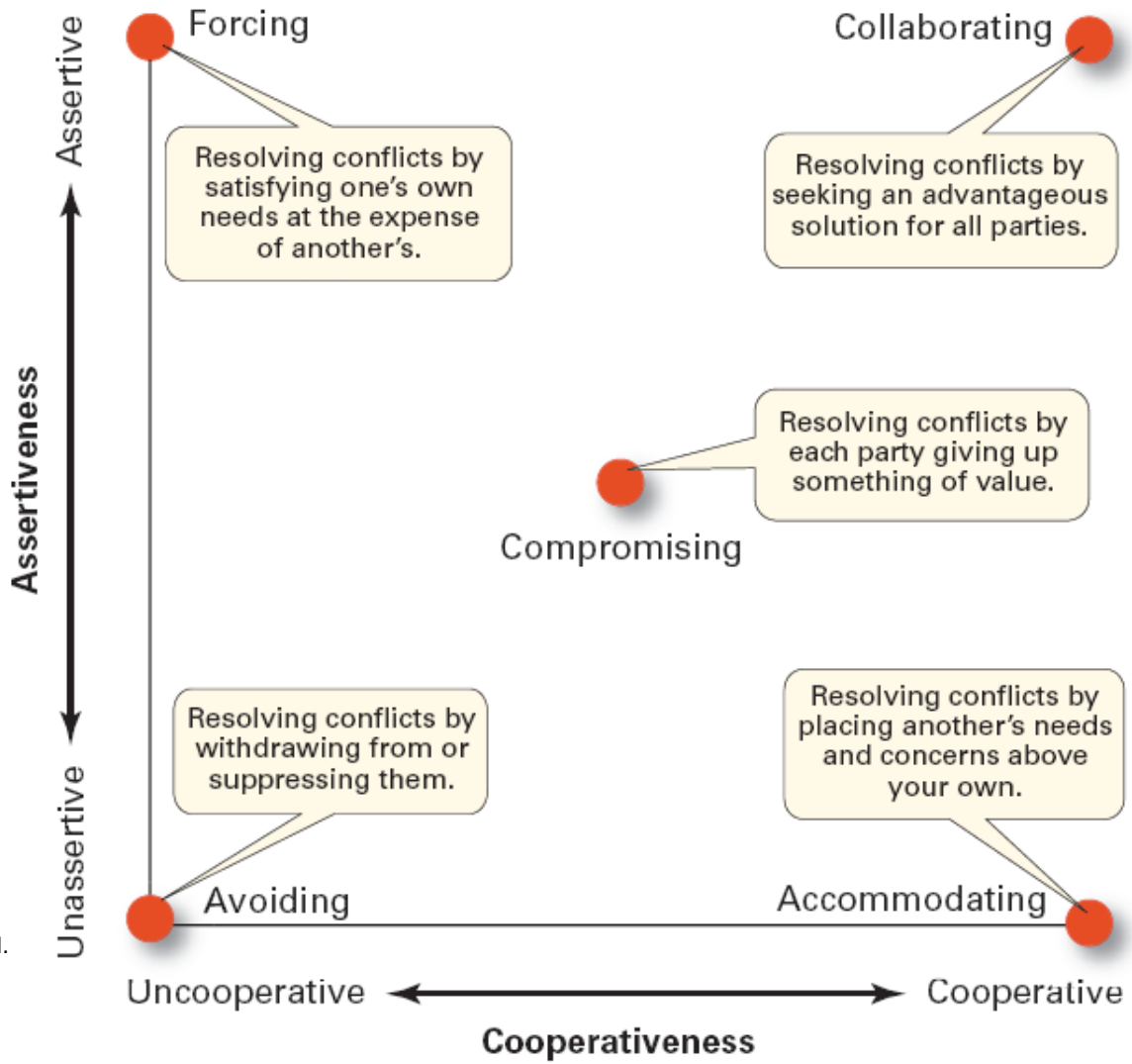
Exhibit 15–9 Conflict-Management Techniques



Source: Adapted from K.W. Thomas, "Conflict and Negotiation Processes in Organizations," in M.D. Dunnette and L.M. Hough (eds.) *Handbook of Industrial and Organizational Psychology*, vol. 3, 2d ed. (Palo Alto, CA: Consulting Psychologists Press, 1992), p. 668. With permission

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Group Tasks and Group Effectiveness

- Highly complex and interdependent tasks require:
  - Effective communications: discussion among group members.
  - Controlled conflict: More interaction among group members.

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What Is a Team?

- Work Team
  - A group whose members work intensely on a specific common goal using their positive synergy, individual and mutual accountability, and complementary skills.
- Types of Teams
  - Problem-solving teams
  - Self-managed work teams
  - Cross-functional teams
  - Virtual teams

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Exhibit 15–10 Groups versus Teams

Work Group	Team
• Strong, clearly focused leader	• Shared leadership roles
• Individual accountability	• Individual and mutual accountability
• The group's purpose is the same as the broader organizational mission	• Specific team purpose that the team itself delivers
• Individual work products	• Collective work products
• Runs efficient meetings	• Encourages open-ended discussion and active problem-solving meetings
• Measures its effectiveness indirectly by its influence on others (such as financial performance of the business)	• Measures performance directly by assessing collective work products
• Discusses, decides, and delegates together	• Discusses, decides, and does real work

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Types of Teams

- Problem-solving Teams
  - Employees from the same department and functional area who are involved in efforts to improve work activities or to solve specific problems.
- Self-managed Work Teams
  - A formal group of employees who operate without a manager and responsible for a complete work process or segment.

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Types of Teams (cont'd)

- Cross-functional Teams
  - A hybrid grouping of individuals who are experts in various specialties and who work together on various tasks.
- Virtual Teams
  - Teams that use computer technology to link physically dispersed members in order to achieve a common goal.

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Advantages of Using Teams

- Teams outperform individuals.
- Teams provide a way to better use employee talents.
- Teams are more flexible and responsive.
- Teams can be quickly assembled, deployed, refocused, and disbanded.

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Exhibit 15–11 Characteristics of Effective Teams

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Characteristics of Effective Teams

- Have a clear understanding of their goals.
- Have competent members with relevant technical and interpersonal skills.
- Exhibit high mutual trust in the character and integrity of their members.
- Are unified in their commitment to team goals.
- Have good communication systems.
- Possess effective negotiating skills
- Have appropriate leadership
- Have both internally and externally supportive environments

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Current Challenges in Managing Teams

- Getting employees to:
  - Cooperate with others
  - Share information
  - Confront differences
  - Sublimate personal interest for the greater good of the team

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Managing Global Teams

- Group Member Resources
  - Unique cultural characteristics of team members
  - Avoiding stereotyping
- Group Structure
  - Conformity—less groupthink
  - Status—varies in importance among cultures
  - Social loafing—predominately a Western bias
  - Cohesiveness—more difficult to achieve
- Group processes—capitalize on diverse ideas
- Manager's role—a communicator sensitive to the type of globe team to use.

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Exhibit 15–12 Drawbacks and Benefits of Global Teams

Drawbacks	Benefits
• Dislike team members • Mistrust team members • Stereotyping • Communication problems • Stress and tension	• Greater diversity of ideas • Limited groupthink • Increased attention on understanding others' ideas, perspectives, etc.

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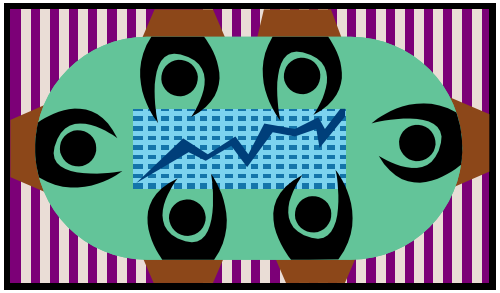
Understanding Social Networks

- Social Network
  - The patterns of informal connections among individuals within groups
- The Importance of Social Networks
  - Relationships can help or hinder team effectiveness
  - Relationships improve team goal attainment and increase member commitment to the team.



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Terms to Know

- group
- forming
- storming
- norming
- performing
- adjourning
- role
- norms
- groupthink
- status
- social loafing
- group cohesiveness
- conflict
- traditional view of conflict
- human relations view of conflict
- interactionist view of conflict
- functional conflicts
- dysfunctional conflicts
- task conflict
- relationship conflict
- process conflict
- work teams

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